



Put It in Order

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Students read a set of mixed-up step-cards and put them in the right order to make a working algorithm, then do a second one on their own. Ordering the steps of a task is creating a sequential algorithm — a computational representation of an everyday procedure (C3.1) — and noticing that swapping steps breaks it touches C3.2.

Ontario curriculum (Grade 1 — C3 Coding)

C3.1 — solve problems and create computational representations of mathematical situations by writing and executing code, including code that involves sequential events.

C3.2 — read and alter existing code, including code that involves sequential events, and describe how changes to the code affect the outcomes.

Materials

The printed worksheet and a pencil. Optional: cut the four cards apart so students can physically slide them into order before writing.

Run it (about 20 min)

1. I DO: read the plant-a-seed cards aloud. 'What must happen first? You can't drop a seed with no hole — so dig first.'
2. WE DO: Exercise 1 — number the cards C-A-D-B. Exercise 2 — write the letters C, A, D, B.
3. YOU DO: Exercise 3 — wash hands in order: wet, soap, rinse, dry (B, C, D, A).
4. Connect: 'Steps in the right order make an algorithm — computers need their steps in order too.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Ex 1 / Ex 2 — Plant a seed: dig a hole (C), drop the seed (A), cover the seed (D), water it (B). Order: C, A, D, B.

Ex 3 — Wash hands: wet hands (B), rub on soap (C), rinse hands (D), dry hands (A). Order: B, C, D, A.

Why the order works: each step depends on the one before — you must dig before you drop, wet before you soap. Swap two and the job fails (drying before washing leaves hands dirty).

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: ordering by the card letters (A-B-C-D) instead of by the task — remind students the letters are just names, not the order.

Simplify: do the plant-a-seed task only, acting each step out together first.

Extend: ask students to name another everyday algorithm (e.g. making toast) and list its steps in order.

Success indicator: the child writes C, A, D, B and B, C, D, A and can explain why a step must come before another.